

100.3 "REALLY," "FAIRLY," AND "PRETTY"

A few adverbs can be used with both gradable and non-gradable adjectives. They are "really" (meaning "very much"), and "pretty" and "fairly" (both meaning "quite a lot, but not very").

What you need is a **really** { **good**
great } idea.

Gradable

Non-gradable



You need to be **fairly** { **confident**
certain } it works.



Inventing a new product is **pretty** { **difficult**
impossible }.



100.4 "QUITE"

"Quite" can be used with both gradable and non-gradable adjectives. In US English, it usually means "very." In UK English, it weakens gradable adjectives to mean "not very," but strengthens non-gradable adjectives to mean "very" or "completely."

Her invention is **quite incredible**.

[Her invention is absolutely fantastic.]

Her idea was **quite good**.

[Her idea was really good. (US)]

[Her idea was good, but not great. (UK)]



FURTHER EXAMPLES

I proposed to my husband.
It was **quite perfect**.



I was **quite upset** when
I lost my pet rabbit.



I find it **quite necessary** to
shower after exercise.



It can be **quite difficult** to adjust
when you move abroad.

